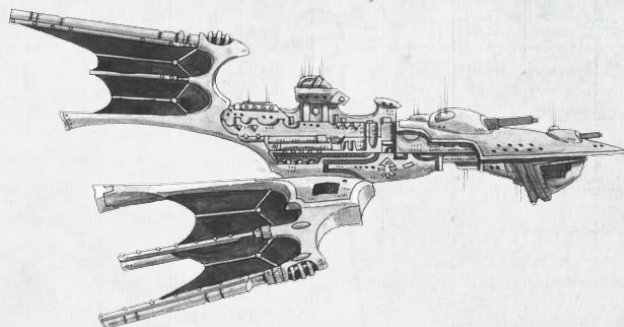


AURORA CLASS LIGHT CRUISER

Famous Ships: Wind Runner, Storm Chaser



TYPE/HITS	SPEED	TURNS	SHIELDS	ARMOUR	TURRETS
Cruiser/4	15/20/30 cm	Special	Holofields	4+	0
ARMAMENT		RANGE/SPEED		FIREPOWER/STR	FIRE ARC
Keel torpedoes		30 cm		4	Front
Prow pulsar lance		30 cm		2	Front

Like the rest of the Eldar ships classified by the Imperial Navy very little is known of the Aurora class. The vessel mimics the design of the larger cruisers with the same sail configuration and hull design. As a light cruiser, logic dictates that the Aurora fulfils the same purpose as the Dauntless serves in the Imperial fleet. Even though Eldar cruisers are fast, the Aurora has the added benefit of the speed and manoeuvrability of an escort but carries firepower to match a cruiser.

The most noted example of the deployment of the Auroras came during the closing stages of the Gothic War. An uneasy alliance was formed between the Imperium and the many Eldar pirate fleets of the sector after the Battle of Gethsemane. This seemed to spur the appearance of many previously unseen Eldar vessels such as the mighty Void Stalker and Aurora light cruisers. The Aurora's first significant engagement recorded in Imperial annals was during an encounter between a fleeing Traitor fleet and a large (and rare) Eldar-Imperial battlegroup deep in the Graildark Nebula. As the Imperial and Traitor fleets ponderously closed in on each other, the Eldar typically peeled off and sped past the Chaos fleet. Admiral Vortigue, who was controlling the Imperial force, was convinced they had done a runner! Shortly after the first long ranged lances began to fire the Eldar reappeared. The majority of the Eldar fleet was directly behind the Traitor ships, however, roughly a third (containing a number of escorts but mainly Auroras) attacked from the flank. The flanking force sped into action flying straight at the Chaos barges, making suicidal strafing runs against the Chaos cruiser hulls. The Chaos fleet was thrown into confusion, ships began to break off formation as their corrupted captains began to take evasive action. A second Eldar squadron approaching from behind then opened fire. Caught facing the oncoming Imperial fleet the Chaos ships could not return fire. Unlike the flanking force a third Eldar squadron held in the rear did not engage up close but maintained a perimeter, to make sure the more manoeuvrable Chaos ships could not turn and escape. Vortigue took his cue and presented his broadsides to the now shambolic Chaos fleet and crossed the "T" to deadly effect.

The Traitor fleet was trapped between two fleets and with a fast and manoeuvrable force taking the Chaos ships close up it was only a matter of hours before the Traitors were utterly destroyed.

FLEET LISTS Eldar Corsairs Fleet List (late war) (pg. 303)